

Orchard OCD Funding Policy

1. Introduction:

Orchard OCD Funding Policy outlines the organisation's approach to financially support research projects dedicated to better understanding, managing, and treating Obsessive-Compulsive Disorder (OCD). The funding avenues available at Orchard OCD are primarily through Calls for Proposals (CFPs) and Collaborations with Academics, as we explain in this document.

2. Objectives:

- 2.1. To promote cutting-edge research in the field of OCD.
- 2.2. To encourage interdisciplinary collaboration among researchers, academics, and Orchard OCD.
- 2.3. To ensure transparency, efficiency, and fairness in the allocation of funds.

3. Funding Routes:

3.1. Calls for Proposals (CFPs):

Objective: Orchard OCD periodically releases Calls for Proposals, inviting researchers and organisations worldwide to submit their innovative OCD-related projects.

Process:

1. Announcement: A Call for Proposals will be announced on the [Orchard OCD website](#), social media platforms, and relevant research forums.
2. Submission: Applicants will submit their proposals through the specified online portal or as directed.
3. Review: Proposals will undergo a rigorous peer review process by a panel of experts, i.e., the Orchard's Scientific Advisory Board (SAB).
4. Selection: Successful proposals will be selected based on key criteria, i.e., relevance, innovation, applicant's track record, feasibility, and potential impact.

Eligibility:

1. Researchers, academics, institutions, or teams with a proven track record in relevant fields.
2. Proposals should align with [Orchard OCD's research priorities](#).

3. Must adhere to ethical guidelines and demonstrate respect for patient confidentiality and rights.

Funding Allocation:

- The maximum and minimum funding limits will be specified in each Call for Proposals.
- Funding will be released in phases or milestones based on the project's progress.

3.2. Collaborations with Academics:

Objective: To establish partnerships with academic institutions, professors, and researchers to jointly develop and execute research projects.

Process:

1. Identification: Orchard OCD identifies potential collaborators or institutions based on their work and reputation. Requests or enquiries for collaboration by academic and research institutions, professors, and departments are also welcomed.
2. Outreach: Orchard OCD approaches the potential collaborator for a partnership, or the potential collaborator approaches Orchard OCD.
3. Discussion: Both parties discuss the project's scope, objectives, and modalities of the collaboration.
4. Agreement: Once a consensus is reached, a formal collaboration agreement is signed.
5. Funding Application: Orchard OCD and its partner work together to apply for funding from a third party, i.e., research funding bodies such as the Medical Research Council (MRC), the National Institute for Health and Care Research (NIHR), the Wellcome, the Economic and Social Research Council (ESRC), or any other relevant body.

Eligibility:

1. Recognised academic and research institutions, departments, and researchers with expertise in OCD or related fields.
2. Willingness to co-share resources, data, results, and authorship.

Funding Allocation:

- Funding will be determined based on the project's needs and the terms of the collaboration agreement.
- Release of funds will be milestone-based or as agreed upon in the collaboration agreement.

4. Monitoring and Reporting:

For both funding routes, recipients are required to:

1. Provide regular progress reports.
2. Adhere to Orchard OCD's reporting guidelines and templates.
3. Be open to periodic reviews and audits.

5. Ethics and Compliance:

All funded projects should:

1. Ensure the highest ethical standards in research.
2. Prioritise patient safety, dignity, and rights.
3. Comply with local and international research regulations.

6. Conclusion:

Orchard OCD is committed to advancing research in the field of OCD through its two primary funding avenues. We invite all eligible researchers and institutions to engage with us in our endeavour to uncover new knowledge and create a positive impact in the OCD community.

For any queries related to the funding policy, please contact margherita@orchardocd.org or visit our [website](#).

This document is subject to revisions and updates as deemed necessary by Orchard OCD.